# 31 Concepts to Build Perfect IB Recruiting Knowledge

Thirty-one concepts, in the order they build — accounting, valuation, M&A, LBO, and markets.

**ACCOUNTING**

1. **The 3-statement linkage**
2. **The $10 depreciation walkthrough**
3. **Working capital & the cash conversion cycle**
4. **Cash vs. accrual accounting**
5. **Deferred revenue & deferred taxes**
6. **EBITDA vs. net income vs. free cash flow**

**VALUATION**

7. **Enterprise value vs. equity value**
8. **The EV bridge (debt, cash, minority interest, preferred)**
9. **Trading comps**
10. **Precedent transactions**
11. **DCF mechanics, start to finish**
12. **WACC & CAPM**
13. **Terminal value: Gordon growth vs. exit multiple**
14. **Unlevered vs. levered free cash flow**
15. **Which method gives the highest value, and why**
16. **Reading a football field**

**M&A**

17. **Accretion / dilution math**
18. **Purchase price allocation & goodwill creation**
19. **Revenue vs. cost synergies**
20. **Cash vs. stock vs. debt consideration**
21. **Stock deal vs. asset deal**
22. **Building a merger model in 6 steps**
23. **Sell-side vs. buy-side process**

**LBO**

24. **Why leverage drives returns**
25. **The paper LBO**
26. **IRR vs. MOIC — what actually moves each**
27. **Debt tranches: revolver, TLA/TLB, high yield, mezz**
28. **Credit stats & covenants**
29. **Capital structure and the cost-of-capital hierarchy**

**MARKETS**

30. **IPO process, ECM vs. DCM**
31. **Rates, the yield curve, and your deal walkthrough**

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